

The Universal Layering Cheat Sheet

Works for any trip. Match the conditions on the left to the layers on the right.

01 QUICK REFERENCE

CONDITIONS	WEAR	NOTE
Clear, mild, calm	Base only	Shell folded in a pocket, just in case
Clear, mild, windy	Base + Shell	Skip the mid layer if you're still moving
Cool, calm	Base + Mid	Shed the mid layer once you're climbing
Cool or cold + wind/rain	All 3 layers	Shell on before you're already wet
Cold, exposed ridge	All 3 + extremities	Hat, gloves, dry socks matter as much as the jacket

02 THE 3-LAYER SYSTEM

BASE

BASE — moves sweat off your skin. Worn on every trip. Never cotton.

MID

MID — traps warm air. On at rest stops, off while climbing hard.

SHELL

SHELL — blocks wind and rain, lets heat escape. Keep it accessible.

Want this for 5 specific trip types?

TrailReady adds packing checklists, quick recipes, and a working spreadsheet for day hikes, backpacking, camping, cold and wet weather.

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